INDICATOR 15.3.2

SDG 15 Life on Land Evidence Report 2025

Mariano Marcos State University · THE Sustainability Impact Ratings 2027

Data year 2025 · Draft for validation · prepared 6 November 2026

SDG assigned	SDG 15 · Life on Land	**Data year**	2025
Team Members	[Name, position]	**Date prepared**	6 November 2026

1 · Sites and platforms explored

Every site and office where evidence for this indicator was found, and where nothing was found. A list of sites is not evidence; it only shows where the team has looked.

#	Site or office	URL or location	What was found
1	The Philippine Star	https://philstar.com	1 item for 15.3.2: From Vanishing Plants to Regional Policy: MMSU Identifies, Conserves and Monitors Threatened Indigenous Food Plants
2	SEARCA publications	https://www.searca.org/pubs	1 item for 15.3.2: From Vanishing Plants to Regional Policy: MMSU Identifies, Conserves and Monitors Threatened Indigenous Food Plants
3	MMSU Research Directorate	https://research.mmsu.edu.ph/news	1 item for 15.3.2: From Vanishing Plants to Regional Policy: MMSU Identifies, Conserves and Monitors Threatened Indigenous Food Plants
4	MMSU News	https://www.mmsu.edu.ph/news	1 item for 15.3.2: From Vanishing Plants to Regional Policy: MMSU Identifies, Conserves and Monitors Threatened Indigenous Food Plants
5	MMSU Extension Directorate	https://extension.mmsu.edu.ph/news	1 item for 15.3.2: From Vanishing Plants to Regional Policy: MMSU Identifies, Conserves and Monitors Threatened Indigenous Food Plants
6	Philippine News Agency (Facebook)	https://www.facebook.com/pnagovph	2 items for 15.3.2: From Vanishing Plants to Regional Policy: MMSU Identifies, Conserves and Monitors Threatened Indigenous Food Plants; Indigenous Food Plants Propagated at the MMSU Botanical Garden Are Shared with Schools and Communities

Not yet explored

Sources the team should still search. Suggestions are listed; add your own.

#	Source to search	Assigned to
1	College and department websites and social media pages	
2	Office records (Registrar, HR, Planning, Procurement, Physical Plant, Student Affairs)	
3	Board of Regents resolutions and memoranda	
4	Extension and Research Directorate pages and accomplishment reports	
5	Agreements (MOA, MOU) with LGUs, agencies, NGOs and industry	
6	News outlets and partner websites (DENR, LGUs, DOST, PhilRice)	
7	[Add a source]	

2 · Indicators to report

SDG 15 · Life on Land · data year 2025

Indicator	Description
15.3.2	Monitoring IUCN and other conservation species. Policy to identify, monitor and protect Red Listed and national conservation list species.

4 · Evidence by indicator

SDG 15.3.2 · Monitoring IUCN and other conservation species (policy)

Have a policy to ensure that IUCN Red List species and national conservation list species with habitats in areas affected by university operations are identified, monitored and protected.

Evidence year: in place by 2025

Submission pick: Indigenous Food Plants Program, https://research.mmsu.edu.ph/news/details/mmsu-research-on-indigenous-food-plants-wins-best-paper-at-suc-acap-2025-conference Weak fit: a research programme, not a policy to identify, monitor and protect IUCN Red List and national-list species. The 2003 classification applied IUCN criteria locally; it is not the IUCN Red List. Attach the RDC resolution and any MMSU policy or species register.

From Vanishing Plants to Regional Policy: MMSU Identifies, Conserves and Monitors Threatened Indigenous Food Plants

2025 activities, with continuing implementation since 2003.



Farmers and local officials trained on alukon (himbabao) propagation, Brgy. 11 Sta. Rosa, Sarrat, 2 May 2025. (Photo: MMSU)



Partners receive indigenous food plant planting materials for the Community Foodscapes and Seedbanks, World Food Day 2025.

Mariano Marcos State University has long identified the plants of Ilocos Norte that are at risk of disappearing. In 2003, MMSU researchers, among them Dr. Miriam Pascua, Ms. Menisa Antonio and Dr. Dionisio Bucao, surveyed Laoag City, Batac, Pasuquin, San Nicolas and Dingras to document plants that elders perceived to be vanishing. Of the 124 plants named, 77 were validated as vanishing by the university's agronomists and horticulturists using criteria of the International Union for Conservation of Nature (IUCN): 45 were classified as endangered and 32 as vulnerable, among them sugod-sugod (Momordica cochinchinensis), kapas-kapas and bignay (Antidesma bunius).

In 2011, the Southeast Asian Regional Center for Graduate Study and Research in Agriculture (SEARCA) published a study by MMSU researchers, "Survey and Characterization of Indigenous Food Plants in Ilocos Norte, Philippines" by Menisa A. Antonio, Rodel T. Utrera, Epifania O. Agustin, Dionisio L. Jamias, Araceli J. Badar and Miriam E. Pascua. Warning that indigenous food plants are disappearing at an alarming rate, the study documented 46 indigenous food plants from 27 plant families in seven upland and remote municipalities of Ilocos Norte, most of them wild species, recorded their identity, uses and locations, and reported that MMSU collects their germplasm and maintains it as living plants and seeds.

This work grew into MMSU's Indigenous Food Plants (IFP) Program, led by Dr. Menisa A. Antonio of the Research Directorate, which documents IFP species in Ilocos Norte and protects them through a triad of conservation approaches: the IFP Botanical Garden (ex situ), a himbabao (alukon) genebank at the MMSU Forest Reserve, circa situ cultivation of the wild yams kamangeg and dolian, and the integration of indigenous food plants into community foodscapes. The program is also advancing omics-based molecular characterization to support their conservation and use. In 2025 it trained 64 farmers and local officials in Sarrat on the propagation of alukon (May 2, 2025) and extended its community seedbanks and foodscapes to new partner barangays in Vintar (October 2025), and its paper "From wild foods to policy innovation: MMSU's indigenous food plants program as a model for sustainable and inclusive agriculture" won Best Paper at the 2025 SUC-ACAP Biennial Conference (August 27–29, 2025).

The IFP Program is the first research and development initiative adopted by the Regional Development Council (RDC) of Region 1, providing input for policy advocacy on the conservation and use of these species. Implementation continues: on June 6, 2026, the Philippine News Agency reported that indigenous food plants such as sugod-sugod, alokon, buga and karot are propagated at the botanical garden of the MMSU Natural Resources Conservation and Management Center and shared with schools and communities for food gardens.

Source

• The Philippine Star, "MMSU researchers identify vanishing plant species," 14 September 2003. https://philstar.com/business/2003/09/14/220344/mmsu-researchers-identify-vanishing-plant-species

• Antonio, M. A., Utrera, R. T., Agustin, E. O., Jamias, D. L., Badar, A. J. and Pascua, M. E. (2011), "Survey and Characterization of Indigenous Food Plants in Ilocos Norte, Philippines," SEARCA Agriculture and Development Discussion Paper No. 2011-2, 61 pp. https://www.searca.org/pubs/discussion-papers?pid=130

• MMSU Research Directorate, “MMSU research on indigenous food plants wins best paper at SUC-ACAP 2025 Conference,” 29 August 2025. https://research.mmsu.edu.ph/news/details/mmsu-research-on-indigenous-food-plants-wins-best-paper-at-suc-acap-2025-conference
• MMSU News, “MMSU trains Sarrat farmers on alukon propagation,” 9 May 2025. https://www.mmsu.edu.ph/news/mmsu-trains-sarrat-farmers-on-alukon-propagation
• MMSU Extension Directorate, “MMSU expands indigenous food plant seedbanks and foodscapes in LGUs,” October 2025. https://extension.mmsu.edu.ph/news/show/389/mmsu-expands-indigenous-food-plant-seedbanks-and-foodscapes-in-lgus
• Philippine News Agency, Facebook post on indigenous food plants at the MMSU Natural Resources Conservation and Management Center botanical garden, 6 June 2026. https://www.facebook.com/pnagovph/posts/1411199747723142/

Indigenous Food Plants Propagated at the MMSU Botanical Garden Are Shared with Schools and Communities

Dated 6 June 2026, after the data year. Internal evidence only; the 2025 foodscape items carry the claim.



Capture: Philippine News Agency post of 6 June 2026 on indigenous food plants propagated at the MMSU NRCMC botanical garden (photos: Leilanie Adriano, PNA).



Partners receive indigenous food plant planting materials for the Community Foodscapes and Seedbanks, World Food Day 2025.

On June 6, 2026, the Philippine News Agency reported that indigenous food plants such as sugod-sugod, alokon, buga and karot are being propagated at the botanical garden of the MMSU Natural Resources Conservation and Management Center in Batac City, Ilocos Norte. The planting materials are shared with schools and community stakeholders for the development of food gardens, to boost food security in the province and provide farmers with an additional source of income.

The botanical garden is part of the ex situ arm of MMSU’s Indigenous Food Plants Program, which in 2025 extended its community foodscapes and seedbanks to new partner barangays (see the 2025 evidence for this indicator).

Source

• Philippine News Agency, Facebook post on indigenous food plants at the MMSU Natural Resources Conservation and Management Center botanical garden, 6 June 2026. https://www.facebook.com/pnagovph/posts/1411199747723142/

Only the submission pick is entered in the portal. The other items are internal evidence.

5 · Before submission

☐	The indicator on page 2 has a submission pick or a note that no evidence was found
☐	One URL per indicator; no page that is only a list of links
☐	A second person opened every URL and saw the answer on the page itself
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☐	Every date falls in the data year, or the policy was in force by then
☐	Nothing was created or backdated for this submission
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☐	Page 1 updated; footer SDG number updated; all grey notes and example rows deleted

Open items for this indicator

☐ Attach the RDC Region 1 resolution and any MMSU policy or species register.
☐ Do not describe the 2003 classification as the IUCN Red List.